IELTS Turbo · Week 9 · Wednesday · Listening and Reading

Business and marketing

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: Business and the art of selling (175 words)

Every successful company starts with an idea and a plan. A bold **entrepreneur** opens a small **startup**, then must **win over** investors to survive. The success of a firm depends on **demand** and **supply**, and on its ability to turn good ideas into **revenue**. A business that sells its goods through its own **outlet** is a **retail** seller, while one that sells large quantities to shops works as a **wholesale** supplier.

A modern **supply chain** links factories, ports and shops, and any disruption can threaten the whole operation. When a firm decides to **launch** a product, it must beat a rival **competitor** and protect its name with a **trademark**. A growing firm may buy a **franchise** or agree a **merger**, increasing its **market share** and total **turnover**. Some companies thrive in a **niche market**, where few rivals exist.

Costs matter too. High **overhead** expenses can reduce **profit**, and each **shareholder** expects a return. Above all, **customer loyalty** is hard to win and easy to lose, so successful firms **go the extra mile** to keep their buyers happy.

Useful phrases from the article

Phrase	Meaning
win over	persuade
go the extra mile	make an extra effort

The 20 new words

Word		Meaning	Example
entrepreneur	n	a person who starts new businesses	*The entrepreneur opened three cafes.*
startup	n	a new small business	*The startup raised money from investors.*
revenue	n	the money a company receives	*Revenue rose by ten percent.*
market share	n	the part of sales a company controls	*The firm has a large market share.*
customer loyalty	n	customers who keep buying from you	*Discounts build customer loyalty.*
competitor	n	a rival company	*The competitor lowered its prices.*
merger	n	the joining of two companies	*The merger created a global giant.*
supply chain	n	the steps from making to selling goods	*The supply chain was disrupted.*

demand	n	the wish of buyers to purchase	*Demand for electric cars is growing.*
supply	n	the amount of goods available	*A shortage of supply raised prices.*
shareholder	n	a person who owns part of a company	*Shareholders received a dividend.*
turnover	n	the total amount of sales	*The shop's turnover doubled.*
launch	v	to put a new product on sale	*They launched the app in June.*
trademark	n	a symbol or name legally owned by a firm	*The trademark is protected by law.*
outlet	n	a shop selling products of one company	*The company has fifty outlets.*
wholesale	adj	selling in large amounts to shops	*Wholesale prices are lower.*
retail	n	selling goods to the public	*Retail sales fell in winter.*
franchise	n	permission to use a company's name and methods	*He bought a coffee franchise.*
overhead	n	regular costs of running a business	*High rent increases overheads.*
niche market	n	a small, special part of the market	*The shop serves a niche market.*

Revision: 10 words from last week

Word		Meaning
dialect	n	a form of a language used in one region
bilingual	adj	able to speak two languages
accent	n	the way a person pronounces words
vocabulary	n	all the words a person knows
grammar	n	the rules of a language
translation	n	changing words into another language
non-verbal	adj	without words
body language	n	messages sent by movements
literacy rate	n	the percentage of people who can read
fluent	adj	able to speak easily

Practice: fill the gaps

outlet · shareholder · market share · startup · overhead · supply chain · trademark · wholesale

1. The company has fifty _____.
2. _____ received a dividend.

3. The firm has a large _____.
4. The _____ raised money from investors.
5. High rent increases _____.
6. The _____ was disrupted.
7. The _____ is protected by law.
8. _____ prices are lower.

More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

accountant (n): a person who manages money records
advertising (n): promoting products
asset (n): something of value
auction (n): a sale to the highest bidder
bankruptcy (n): a state of being unable to pay debts
bargain (n): something bought cheaply
board (n): a group that runs a company
boycott (v): to refuse to buy something
budget (n): a plan for spending
chain store (n): one of many similar shops
client (n): a customer of a professional
commodity (n): a product that can be traded
consumer (n): a buyer
corporation (n): a large company
discount (n): a reduction in price
distribution (n): delivering goods
dividend (n): a share of profit
e-commerce (n): buying and selling online
headquarters (n): the main office
innovation (n): a new idea or method
invoice (n): a bill for goods or services
logistics (n): the organization of moving goods
manager (n): a person in charge
mass-produced (adj): made in large amounts
negotiate (v): to discuss to reach an agreement
packaging (n): the material around a product
partnership (n): a business with two or more owners
product line (n): a range of related products
stakeholder (n): a person with an interest in a business

Answers

1. outlets (outlet)
2. Shareholders (shareholder)
3. market share (market share)
4. startup (startup)
5. overheads (overhead)
6. supply chain (supply chain)
7. trademark (trademark)
8. Wholesale (wholesale)